

WORKED EXAMPLE

Jack Mo reads it aloud

Main switchgear

THE UNTRAINED EYE vs THE RISK MANAGER'S EYE



Jack Mo circles what his eye lands on — and the one thing that should be there and isn't.

To an ordinary eye, these grey cabinets are just more boxes being set on a pad — heavy, dull, finally here, one more delivery checked off. The job feels like it is moving. A risk manager looks at the same cabinets and feels the schedule narrow to a single point. They don't see boxes; they see the main switchgear, the heart of the building's power, a piece built to order that took many months to arrive. The casual eye sees gear that showed up and stops thinking. The trained eye sees everything downstream that was waiting on it — and asks whether it arrived on time, or already late. Nothing electrical can be energized, tested, or commissioned until this is in and connected. So the trained eye traces the thread forward: rough-in stalls behind a slip, commissioning waits on rough-in, turnover waits on commissioning. Then it looks backward, at the buy — was the price locked at bid, or exposed to escalation in the months between? Then it looks down, at the pad — is this thing protected while it sits, or quietly getting damaged before it is ever installed? One delivery, and the whole tail of the job hangs off it. The cabinets did not change between those two readings. The scene did not change; the eye did.

THIS SCENE FEEDS YOUR REGISTER

R5 · R9 · R13 · R17 · R21 — the five students dealt this scene.

The discipline under that read

The moves you run so you can see it too — then five register rows fall out of one glance.

- LOOK

sweep overhead → working level → ground/openings → edges → background (don't lock on the obvious).
- SPLIT

say what you SEE — facts only: Large grey cabinets — the main electrical switchgear — being lifted and set onto their pad, Built-to-order equipment, the kind that takes many months to fabricate and ship, Everything electrical downstream — energizing, testing, commissioning — waits on this single item.
- NOTICE

circle the cues: The switchgear cabinets being set; Storage condition on the pad; The empty rough-in behind it — and the missing No weather protection or secure enclosure around the unit while it waits on the pad — the safeguard that keeps a months-out replacement from becoming necessary is the thing you can't see in the frame.
- ASK → PROJECT

what releases it, who's in the path, what happens next — and in which phase.

NAME · five rows, born from one glance (cause → event → consequence)

- 1

Schedule

Because the switchgear is a built-to-order item that takes many months to arrive, ordering it late may cause the delivery to slip, leading to electrical rough-in stalling behind it and the schedule slipping.

Owner: Project Manager / MEP Coordinator · Trigger: switchgear submittal-to-delivery lead time on the procurement log exceeds the date electrical rough-in is scheduled to start
- 2

Schedule

Because nothing electrical can be energized or tested until the switchgear is installed, a late arrival may delay the start of commissioning, leading to system startup pushing back across the building.
- 3

Schedule

Because the entire turnover depends on commissioning being complete, a slip in switchgear delivery may push commissioning, leading to the building's substantial completion and handover date moving.
- 4

Cost

Because the switchgear is exposed to price escalation in the months between bid and buy, a delayed purchase may lock in a higher price, leading to a budget overrun on the electrical package.
- 5

Quality

Because the switchgear is stored on site before install, exposure to weather or impact may damage the unit, leading to a months-long reorder and rework of the electrical sequence.

READING MOVE · bank this card

"Spot the long-lead keystone item and trace everything that waits on it — when one built-to-order piece gates energizing, commissioning, and turnover, its delivery date is the date the whole job hinges on."

SUCCESS CARD · check the read against these six

- ?

a real, visible cue

?

cause is a site condition

?

a future event

?

consequence on cost/time/quality/safety
- ?

owner + early-warning trigger

?

(M4) P and I each defended

P × I? Not yet — Module 2 IDENTIFIES; Module 4 ASSESSES. These rows seed register rows R5 · R9 · R13 · R17 · R21.